

A Do not bother updating your BIOS, if you don't have a problem with your system. Any locking up during the flashing procedure will result in a board that won't work anymore. If you have to update it, then get the exact model number for your motherboard. Be sure that you are flashing the board with the correct BIOS for your exact motherboard. Look for the motherboard packaging if you still have it. You can also find information when the computer boots. SiSoft Sandra can also help you find the exact model number. The 915GV chipset supports both DDR and DDR2. DDR 400 and DDR2 533 are supported, but you cannot use both at the same time.

PC Configuration

Q I'm planning to buy a new PC. It would basically be a gaming rig (FPS and racing games). Can you please suggest a configuration for this PC? My budget is Rs 50,000-51,000. I would prefer it to be future-proof for at least three to four years.

Would there be any significant performance gain (better gameplay) in case of increasing the RAM from the current standard of 2 to 4 GB or 8 GB? If so, what do you recommend?

Is there any need for having a separate sound card, or is the on-board sound solution good enough for hi-fidelity sound experience in gaming and music?

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A A budget of Rs 50,000 should just about get you an Intel Core 2 Duo E8400, a P35-based motherboard from Abit, 4 GB DDR2 RAM, a 640 GB Western Digital hard drive, a 22-inch LCD screen from Dell and a GeForce 9600GT or a 8800GT.

Calling it future proof for three to four years might not be the right thing to say. Games and hardware evolve so quickly that you might find at least the graphics card getting outdated in just around two years from now.

An onboard sound solution will do just fine for all the regular games. But if you plan on buying headphones worth more than Rs 4,000 or speakers over Rs 10,000 or more, then a dedicated sound card is a must.